



"Taking Forward Urban Housing Reconstruction Strategic Issues"

National Consultation workshop to collate learning elements and prepare ground for integration of evidence-based urban strategies into specific government Acts, Policies, Working Procedures and Regulations.

HIGHLIGHTS

- Prime Minister KP Sharma Oli inaugurates the Dharahara Tower marking sixth memorial day of the 2015 earthquake of Nepal
- [NRA to design a ten-year campaign on disaster resilient Nepal](#)
- [NRA & NDRRMA published a Training Manual on Resilient Development Oriented Local Government](#)
- Consultative Meeting on 'Taking Forward Urban Housing Reconstruction Strategic Issues'
- Validation team meeting organized with urban experts
- HRRP team presentation at the UK Shelter Forum 2021 (UKSF27)
- COVID-19 live updates from Ministry of Health and Population (MoHP)

FEATURED TECHNICAL STAFF STORY: Krishna Prasad Gautam, Mobile Mason, Panchkhal Municipality, Kavrepalanchowk



*Krishna Prasad Gautam,
Mobile Mason
Panchkhal Municipality,
Kavrepalanchowk*

Mr. Krishna Prasad Gautam, Mobile Mason, Panchkhal Municipality, Kavrepalanchowk district:

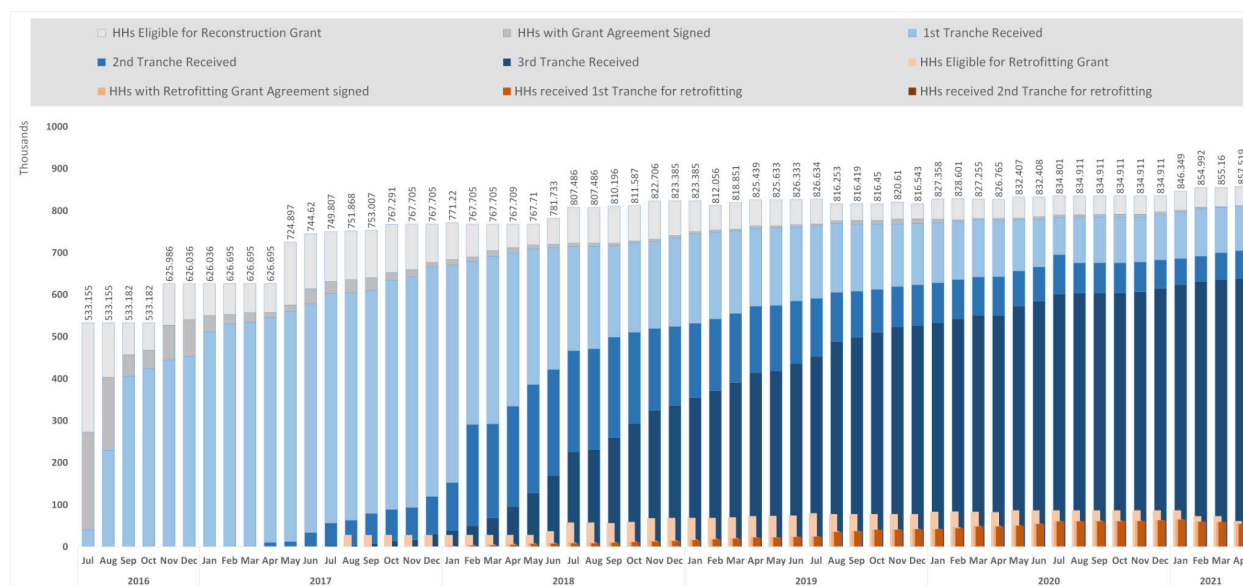
Mobile mason of Panchkhal Municipality of Kavrepalanchowk district, Krishna Prasad Gautam was much occupied in rebuilding houses of vulnerable members of the community. Mr. Guatam has spent 30 years in the housing construction, from working as laborer to mason. He is now working as a mason for the DLPIU - Building. Ward Representatives and Ward Engineers are quite delighted with his devotion and proactiveness towards rebuilding the devastated houses.

NATIONAL UPDATES

NRA, CLPIU GMAI and Building. Grant Disbursement Data, as of 26 April 2021

**N/A indicates that the information source was not accessible at the time of reporting*

Reconstruction Grant	28 December	25 January	22 February	29 March	26 April
Total No. Eligible HHs	834911	846349	854992	855160	857519
HHs Enrolled	796282	800973	808489	809711	811754
HHs Received 1st Tranche	790266	796809	804978	807908	810635
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	681953	685600	691264	699351	704429
HHs Received 3rd Tranche	614642	624096	631203	636252	638490
Retrofit Grant	28 December	25 January	22 February	29 March	26 April
Total No. Eligible HHs	78033	64887	65162	65309	54715
HHs Enrolled	57319	54580	53795	53298	48469
HHs Received 1st Tranche	56478	54723	53728	53278	48454
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	332	339	368	418	445



Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA GMAI CLPIU data as of 26 April. 2021

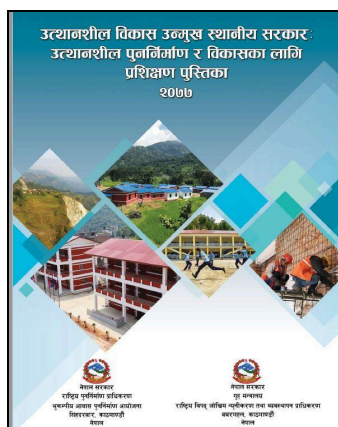
National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) marks the sixth memorial day of the devastating 2015 earthquake of Nepal through various programs, 24-25 April: The Right Honourable Prime Minister, KP Sharma Oli, inaugurated the newly-reconstructed 22-storey historic Dharahara amidst a special function organized on 24 April at the Dharahara premises in Sundhara. During the inaugural session, the video record of the

tragic day of 25 April 2015 was shown with a minute of silence in memory of the lost lives by the 2015 Nepal Earthquake. The Master Plan of Dharahara, which constitutes the construction of an underground parking lot, a garden, an earthquake museum, a colorful fountain, an exhibition hall, shops and stone spout was also shown. The Chief Executive Officer of NRA, Sushil Gyewali stated that the reconstruction progress made by NRA has been satisfactory in all sectors of private housing reconstruction, public buildings, school buildings and security buildings, heritage monuments including other physical infrastructure. He further informed that the Government of Nepal plans to share Nepal's reconstruction experiences by organizing an International Conference on Nepal's Reconstruction (ICNR) by the end of year 2021. The Prime Minister thanked the NRA and all those partners who supported Nepal's reconstruction campaign. Similarly, on 25 April 2021, NRA organized an interaction program on "Post-earthquake Reconstruction, its Contribution in Building Resilient Society and Future Roadmap", where development partners and Government experts presented their reflections on Nepal's reconstruction and future roadmap following the comprehensive presentation by NRA Executive Committee Member, Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha on the post-earthquake reconstruction and its contribution in building resilient society. The speakers highlighted the need to strengthen National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) as the successor of NRA along with the capacity building of local governments for disaster resilient Nepal. NRA is aiming to complete private housing reconstruction by the end of July 2021 whereas other incomplete reconstruction works will be handed over to respective government line ministries and local governments.

NRA to design a ten-year campaign on disaster resilient Nepal. 13 April: The NRA in joint collaboration with NDRRMA is to prepare a long term proposal to implement long-term disaster management plan to rebuild heritage settlements and cultural monuments in the world heritage sites including recovery and rehabilitation in the Kathmandu Valley districts. This will be implemented from the next fiscal year as a long-term campaign to achieve results in line with the global goals i.e. Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). This initiative was decided by the 18th meeting of the NRA Steering Committee chaired by Prime Minister KP Sharma Oli. The meeting also decided to organize an International Conference on Nepal's Reconstruction (ICNR) at the end of November or

early December 2021, in coordination with the Ministry of Foreign Affairs , considering the timing of “Sagarmatha Sambad.”¹

The Training Manual on Resilient Development Oriented Local Government: The NRA and the NDRRMA have jointly prepared a training manual for the purpose of training to local government stakeholders. This manual includes the Government of Nepal’s strategic work plan, other policy and structural provision, disaster-resilient buildings and infrastructure. It also deals with weather and climate resilience, natural resource management for disaster resilience, resilient agriculture, resilient education sector and financing issues for disaster resilience among others.



The Earthquake Housing Reconstruction Project (EHRP) organized a series of workshops from February to March 2021 with the objective of strengthening local governments in disaster management. A total 1,656 local government representatives and staff from 282 local governments participated in the workshops. The workshop was first held on 8 February in Kavrepalanchowk in which elected Chiefs, Deputy Chiefs, Chief Administrative Officer, Disaster Coordination Committee Coordinator, Ward Members and staff of eight local governments units had participated. The local governments bodies appreciated and thanked NRA-EHRP for organizing such workshops for the representatives of local governments.

Elected representatives of Bhaktapur Municipality observed heritage recovery and reconstruction activities of Lalitpur Metropolitan City

On 20 April 2021, a team of elected representatives and heads of Bhaktapur Municipality including Mayor, Mr. Sunil Prajapati, and Deputy Mayor, Mrs. Rajani Joshi and a few Ward Chiefs visited and observed the heritage reconstruction initiatives undertaken at Patan Durbar Square premises of Lalitpur Metropolitan City (LMC).

¹ The Sagarmatha Sambaad is a multi-stakeholder dialogue forum committed to deliberate on the most prominent issues of global, regional and national significance. As a platform, it brings together people from all walks of life from a broader spectrum, having the stake, influence and capacity to shape and drive the discourse for positive change. <https://sagarmathasambaad.org/>

The Mayor of LMC, Mr. Chiribabu Maharjan along with Deputy Mayor, Mrs. Gita Satyal welcomed the guests from Bhaktapur Municipality and clarified that this kind of cross sharing and learning visit program has been organized to exchange best practices and success stories at Municipality level. Both LMC and Bhaktapur Municipality stand out amid the crowd in regard to excellent reconstruction and recovery of heritage monuments as well as recovery of intangible heritage values. Large number of large to medium heritage monuments along with temples were damaged by Nepal earthquake 2015. The visiting team from Bhaktapur also visited the Jyapu Community Museum located at Jyapu Pragya Bhawan in Ward no 9, Gachhen Tole and has taken extracts of initiatives of preserving the nearly a century old intangible cultural heritage values of Jyapu communities. The activities of local emergency operations center (LEOC), city beautification activities and other disaster risk reduction activities operated under LMC were also briefed to the visiting team. The visiting team from Bhaktapur praised the initiatives of heritage recovery in modern times too while Mayor Chiribabu Maharjan lauded the exemplary and self-sustaining initiatives of Bhaktapur Municipality in education, heritage and health sector.



Economic Impact Study Update: HRRP is coordinating the Economic Impact Study executed by a team of three independent consultants, technically supported by NRA. As of 26 April, 3,345 out of 6,600 households have responded to survey questions. HRRP District teams in close collaboration and coordination with DLPIU-Building are providing

coordination services and facilitating consultants for timely completion of the survey questions. For more information, contact HRRP District Management Team - Coordinator, Mr. Sufi Mohammad Faiz (9851241401) dmt.coord@hrrpnepal.org

For economic impact survey at the district level, following contact persons can be contacted at the District [Focal Point for NRA Socio-Economic Impact Survey](#).

Consultative Meeting on 'Taking Forward Urban Housing Reconstruction Strategic Issues'

On 02 April, a one-day consultative meeting titled "Taking Forward Urban Housing Reconstruction Strategic Issues" was held in Kathmandu with the objective of obtaining endorsement on the study approach and to discuss key issues and gaps in the identified policies and legal provisions in the context of ongoing urban recovery. The event was organized by the NRA/CLPIU-Building and supported by CRS, NSET, UKAID and HRRP. This was the first wider consultative meeting as part of the ongoing new consultancy study on urban issues is commissioned by NRA with technical support by NSET, CRS and HRRP, and the lead consultant is Surya Bhakta Sangachhe, Urban expert. The objective of the study is to collate learning elements and prepare ground for integration of evidence-based urban strategies into specific government Acts, Policies, Working procedures and Regulation. Dr. Chandra B. Shrestha, Executive Member & ICNR Convener, presented the overview and objective of the consultation meeting and moderated the technical session. NRA Chief Executive Officer (CEO) Sushil Gyewali, the chief guest, including three expert commentators namely Ram Thapa, of Kathmandu Metropolitan City (KMC), Surendra Govinda Joshi, from Lalitpur Metropolitan City (LMC), Krishna Prasad Sapkota, Executive Director of Town Development Fund provided comments on the presentation at the event and spoke about current strategic issues on urban housing following the presentation by Mr. Sangacche and Surya Narayan Shrestha, Executive Director of NSET. Special guests, Sunil Prajapati, Mayor of Bhaktapur Municipality and Subarna Shrestha, Mayor of Shankharapur Municipality addressed the sessions and gave their valuable views and opinions on the issues and dynamics on urban housing, heritage among others. The expert members of the validation team also addressed the technical session. The meeting was held in hybrid model (in-person and virtual) and was streamed live on both NRA and HRRP Facebook pages as well as on YouTube channel. Over 65 people attended including 13

female participants. For further information, contact-Bishan Wagle, Urban Coordination Officer, uco@hrrpnepal.org

Validation team meeting organized with urban experts

On 12 April, the National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) organized a validation team meeting to discuss validation of the issues that came up in the consultation meeting “Taking Forward Urban Housing Strategic Issues” organized earlier, on 2 April. This was a follow up meeting focused on the comments, feedback and suggestions and way forward.

The event was moderated by Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha, NRA Executive Committee member. It included a brief recapitulation by the consultant team and proposed way forward, presented by lead Consultant Surya Bhakta Sangacche and NSET Executive Director and Disaster Management Expert, Surya Naryan Shrestha. The team summarised the issues of urban housing recovery and reconstruction which were: limited access to finance, land, heritage settlement, communication, socio-technical assistance, retrofitting, assistance for urban poor and vulnerable community and policies and also summarized the key existing laws.

The briefing followed by sharing of views from the 5 expert members validation team which included three former secretaries of GoN, Purna Kadariya, Kishor Thapa and Dipendra Nath Sharma as well as Sangita Shrestha, Managing Director of Dwarika’s Hotel, and Ramesh Maharjan, President, Maya Foundation.

In his special remarks and agenda of trailblazing, NRA CEO, Sushil Gyewali as the chief guest, provided guidance and direction to the study team. Dr. Chandra, provided the way forward at the closing session. Secretary of NRA Mani Ram Gelal and Director General of DUDBC, Nabaraj Pyakurel also addressed the meeting.

A total of 18 participants, including high-level senior NRA officials, CLPIU-Building team, and experts, study team members from NSET, CRS and HRRP were present. For further information contact-Bishan Wagle, Urban Coordination Officer- uco@hrrpnepal.org.

HRRP team presentation at the UK Shelter Forum 2021 (UKSF27)

During 22-23 April this year, the 27th edition of the UK Shelter Forum (UKSF27) was organized virtually by the UK Shelter Forum team. **On 22 April**, Ms. Bhubaneswari Parajuli, National Coordinator-Technical and Mr. Bishan Wagle, Urban Coordination officer from HRRP presented at the first session of the UKSF27UK held in the afternoon of 22 April (London Time) a paper titled 'Underlying constraints of urban housing recovery in post-Earthquake Nepal'. More than 110 participants were in attendance during the presentation.

The UK Shelter Forum is a community of practice for individuals and organisations involved in shelter and settlement reconstruction activities after disasters. Also at this year's UKSF, besides the main agenda, there was a lecture by Dr Chandra Bahadur Shrestha, Executive Committee Member of NRA on the achievements and lessons from the work of the NRA over the six years since the 2015 Gorkha earthquake. This special session was held on 23rd of April. The UKSF team will shortly post the recordings and the presentations on the UK Shelter Forum website & Youtube channel. UKSF agenda is at: <http://www.shelterforum.info/wp-content/uploads/2021/04/UKSF27-Agenda-2.pdf> For further information please contact-Bishan Wagle, Urban Coordination Officer; uco@hrrpnepal.org

Urban Webinar Series organized on "Sustainable Urban Regeneration of Heritage Settlements for Nepal's Urban Recovery and Development"

On 31 March, HRRP together with Urban Reconstruction Technical Working Group (UR-TWG), CRS & UKAID organized the third Urban Webinar Series with a theme "Sustainable Urban Regeneration of heritage settlements for Nepal's Urban Recovery and Development". Urban Webinar Series is a virtual gathering for sharing learnings from Nepal's urban housing recovery and intends to connect these learnings to longer term Nepal's urban development visions in order to facilitate efficient, sustainable and inclusive urban settlement recovery. The Webinar Series intended to offer a platform for national and international knowledge sharing on urban housing recovery issues, best practices and success stories.

In this webinar, three speakers, Jharna Joshi, Rana Amirtahmasebi and Lumanti Joshi shared their experiences, learnings and knowledge on the broader theme and given topics. Presenting on the topic 'Urban Regeneration Through Heritage Conservation and Tourism-Lessons Learnt from Bandipur, Nepal' Jharna Joshi, heritage and tourism specialist, shared the experiences and overview of the Bandipur Eco-Cultural Tourism Project (BECTP) and the lessons learnt.

Likewise, Rana Amirtahmasebi, urban development professional, presented on the topic 'Regenerating urban land- a practitioners perspective' where she shared global experiences with examples of various urban regeneration projects and initiatives in various cities across the world. Also, third speaker, Lumanti Joshi, Program Manager-Housing at LUMANTI Support Group for Shelter Nepal, presented on the topic 'Participatory Heritage Recovery plan of historic Settlement for Green Growth and Sustainable Tourism in Nepal' and spoke on the heritage recovery plan and historic settlements. The event included a Q&A. The Webinar recording can be accessed [here](#).

COVID-19 live updates from Ministry of Health and Population (MoHP)

According to the Ministry of Health & Population (MoHP) [website](#) data, as of 25 April 2021, total cumulative new cases are 300,119 (Male-193,593 & Female-106,526) out of which 277,573 (92.49%) have recovered and 19,382 (6.46%) are undergoing medical treatment in isolation. So far, 3,164 (1.05%) have lost their lives due to COVID-19. The MoHP has operationalized two call centers **1115 (from 6 am - 10 pm)** and **1133 (24 hours)** to provide counselling services regarding COVID-19 prevention and treatment.

DISTRICT & MUNICIPAL UPDATES

In **Lalitpur**, engineers and social mobilizers are tracking details of beneficiaries who did not withdraw the first tranche amount from the banks. They are also tracking details of double paid beneficiaries in Godawari Municipality. Social Mobilizers did consultation with ward chairpersons of Godawari Municipality to inform double paid beneficiaries to return tranche amounts through public notice.

In **Bhaktapur**, engineers and social mobilizers are doing door-to-door visits to track beneficiaries who have not received subsequent tranche after receiving second tranche.

Municipal and Ward based NRA engineers are facilitating beneficiaries on how to apply for second and third tranche. Under the technical supervision of Engineers, mobile masons are continuously working on reconstructing houses for vulnerable beneficiaries.

In **Kathmandu**, a total of 19,180 households have completed their housing reconstruction, while 26,835 houses are under construction. So far, 59 beneficiaries of the district have recently changed their beneficiary type from retrofitting to reconstruction and 127 beneficiaries changed their beneficiary type to retrofitting from reconstruction. DLPIU - Building is collecting details of the beneficiaries having multiple ownership. Engineers and Technical Staff along with HRRP staff conducted a joint monitoring field Visit at Gokarneshwor Municipality on 5 April 2021. During the field visit, 15 houses of ward 1, 2, 3, 4, and 8 were visited. Findings of field visit were; majority of the retrofit beneficiaries are interested to change beneficiary types to reconstruction. Beneficiaries with non-compliance structure, especially with the reinforced concrete frame structure, are not willing to apply correction measures. Out of the 67 retrofit beneficiaries of the Municipality, only 62 beneficiaries have signed the partnership agreement and received the first tranche. Only one beneficiary has received a total tranche under the retrofit category. Reportedly, beneficiaries have been requesting for a second tranche under retrofitting only after doing minor repairs. This shows beneficiaries still have confusion between repair and retrofit because of which retrofitting progress is taking time. DLPIU - Building has deployed mobile masons to support on retrofitting to the beneficiaries who are willing to retrofit their house as per the NRA guideline. DLPIU - Building is also collecting details of landless beneficiaries who received NPR 200,000 from NRA and have purchased land for relocation. DLPIU - GMaLI has forwarded details of beneficiaries who have requested Grant Partnership Agreement in the ward to CLPIU. DLPIU - Building organized Training of Trainers (ToT) from 18 to 20 April 2021 under "Making Homes Accessible for All". The training was attended by 14 participants from Kathmandu, nine from Lalitpur, and five from Makwanpur.

In **Makwanpur**, Senior Division Engineer of Earthquake Housing Reconstruction Program Narayan Prasad Shrestha and his team conducted a field monitoring on 29 March 2021. A brief meeting was also held at DLPIU-GMaLI Office to discuss the reconstruction action plan.

In **Sindhupalchowk**, out of 89,390 partnership agreement number, collection of 83,330 is completed. DLPIU-GMaLI is currently engaged in supervision, monitoring, and quality control works of 15 under-reconstruction monasteries (Gumba). DLPIU-GMaLI finance and MIS team are working on data reconciliation along with the Bank and the treasury office of GMaLI. Tranche disbursement has been halted due to delay in budget release. DLPIU-Building is continuously working on tranche certification handover and rendering technical assistance for reconstruction. DLPIU-Building is also engaged in supervision, monitoring, and quality control works of seven under reconstruction monasteries and hospitals. DLPIU- building has successfully completed ToT to Engineers under "Making Homes Accessible to All" program during 6- 8 April 2021, where 25 engineers participated.

In **Nuwakot**, 1,106 beneficiaries have converted their beneficiary types from retrofitting to reconstruction beneficiaries. Focal Engineers and Ward based Engineers along with social mobilizers are engaged in household surveys for Economic Impact Study.

In **Rasuwa**, 83 retrofitting beneficiaries have converted their beneficiary types into reconstruction, where the majority of the beneficiaries have completed reconstruction upto DPC level.

In **Kavrepalanchowk**, DLPIU engineers engaged in collection of Partnership Agreement (PA). Technical staff are involved in distribution of house completion certificates. DLPIU - GMaLI has started the disbursement process of the pending tranche and has requested the Finance Comptroller General Office to release a budget. DLPIU-GMaLI has also started tracking tranche duplication details of double paid beneficiaries. Budget is also released for landless beneficiaries to purchase land. In this month, 2,628 beneficiaries have received second tranche while 1,240 have received third tranche. Of the 85 earthquake beneficiaries of Panchkhal Municipality, list of 51 beneficiaries are forwarded to DCC meeting for enlisting them into vulnerable earthquake affected beneficiaries.

In **Solukhumbu**, 30 percent reconstruction data management work is completed. Joint Monitoring Field visit was conducted at ward-6 of Mapya Dudhkoshi Rural Municipality dated from 6 to 7 April 2021. Sotang Rural Municipality and Mahakulung Rural Municipality were visited on 8 April 2021 and 9 April 2021 respectively. Joint Monitoring Field Visit was

accompanied by Social MIS Specialist of GMaLI and District Focal Engineer along with Hub Team General Coordinator of HRRP. Various reconstruction issues such as delay in accessing the third tranche amount, beneficiaries dissatisfaction on dismantling partially damaged houses, and beneficiaries unaware of reconstruction time frame were identified. During the Joint Monitoring Field Visit, orientation on the Economic Impact Study was also provided to Ward Engineers.

HRRP District Coordination Team Bhaktapur, Lalitpur Monthly Report, 25 Mar - 21 Apr 2021



Ward-8, Lubhu, Mahalaxmi Municipality, Lalitpur: Two roomed BMC house with flexible roof. The owner has received all the subsequent tranches from Government Housing Grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dolakha, Ramechhap, Sindhuli Monthly Report, 25 Mar - 21 Apr 2021



Ward-7, Khadadevi Rural Municipality, Ramechhap: Single storey with an attic made up of stone in mud mortar. The house owner has applied for the third tranche.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu Monthly Report, 25 Mar - 21 Apr 2021



Ward-2, Kathmandu Metropolitan City. Two storey RCC structure house. The beneficiary has received all the tranche under Government Housing Grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kavrepalanchok Monthly Report, 25 Mar - 21 Apr 2021



Ward-10, Panchkhal Municipality, Kavrepalanchowk: Brick in Cement Mortar House under construction through the support of DLIPU Mason. House owner is a senior citizen and has processed for the second tranche.

HRRP District Coordination Team Makwanpur Cluster Monthly Report, 25 Mar – 21 Apr 2021



Ward-3, Hetauda Sub-Metropolitan City, Makwanpur: Single Storey house with hollow concrete block structure with two rooms. House owner has received all tranches from the Government Housing Grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Solukhumbu Cluster Monthly Report, 25 Mar – 21 Apr 2021



Ward-3, Mahakulung Rural Municipality, Solukhumbu: Stone in Mud Mortar House with RCC Band. The House Owner has received all the tranches from the Government Housing Grant and also received a house completion certificate.

HRRP District Coordination Team Rasuwa, Nuwakot Monthly Report, 25 Mar – 21 Apr 2021



Ward-12, Bidur Municipality, Nuwakot: Mobile Masons supporting single women. Hollow Concrete Block with two room house under construction.

HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhupalchowk Monthly Report, 25 Mar - 21 Apr 2021



Ward-4, Bhotekoshi Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchowk: Load Bearing Structure house with stone and cement mortar masonry with RCC bands and CGI roofing.

FEATURED STORY



Krishna Prasad Gautam, Mobile Mason, Panchkhal Municipality, Kavrepalanchowk:

Mobile mason of Panchkhal Municipality of Kavrepalanchowk district, Krishna Prasad Gautam was much occupied in rebuilding houses of vulnerable members of the community. Mr.

Guatam has spent 30 years in the housing construction, from working as laborers to mason. He is now working as a mason for DLPIU - Building. His current work priority is to reconstruct 20 houses of vulnerable beneficiaries. While working, he also teaches earthquake resilient technologies and methods to other unskilled laborers and houseowner.

Mr Guatam is supporting house reconstruction of beneficiaries enlisted in NRA's vulnerable category as well other vulnerable beneficiaries not enlisted in NRA's vulnerable category. Besides this, he is also supporting the transportation of construction materials in rural vicinity. Ward Representatives and Ward Engineers are quite delighted with his devotion and proactiveness towards rebuilding the devastated house. Ward Engineers informed that he has also been to them on collection of partnership agreement, getting reconstruction updates from beneficiaries, and engaged surveys requested from CLPIU/DLPIU. He is hopeful that reconstruction of houses belonging to vulnerable beneficiaries will be completed on the timeframe of NRA. He is grateful to the NRA and the local governments for providing opportunity to serve his community. He lastly shares, "Experience and skills gained from reconstruction is his valuable asset."

CASE STORY

"BUILD BACK SAFER" (Story and Photo Credit By Nepal Red Cross Society)



"Wow! What a nice house". While visiting Uttargaya Rural Municipality in Rasuwa district , our eyes stuck in an attractive house. The time when we reached the home, Patali Gurung, aged 50, was in her kitchen. With our voice of requesting words to come out, she came and smilingly offered to sit on the bench. We started our conversation. While talking we came to know that she lost her husband 12 years ago. She struggled a lot to bring up her sons at the time. Hardly, she used to manage her daily life. However, life was going fine, and suddenly the massive earthquake left her life more struggling. Everything was damaged including her house, food items and livestock. Life remains struggling again. As a saying 'Hard time doesn't always remain' she also got a good day when Nepal Red Cross Society supported her to construct the house. Like others in the community, she also received the first tranche, but due to lack of enough manpower in the community she could not start

the construction. She says, "We were unable to start the house due to lack of manpower in our community. Red Cross started to make groups of community people and started the Aalo-Palo system which was not a new term to us, but it was not in practice since 10-12 years. Red Cross helped in re-starting the intervention again in our community." When we made a query on Aalo-Palo, she added, "We make the group of people, and work on a turn-wise basis. We work in a neighbor's house free of cost till the house's DPC level is completed by which they don't have the problem of manpower to start construction." Total amount of NPR 3,00,000/- per household was provided by Red Cross in 4 tranches.

She is now happy that they are living in a safe house. "Previously while living in temporary shelter made of CGI, we faced maximum problems during rain, cold, wind storm and even the fare of snake bite. Last time, when a small quake hit, we didn't even feel that. New house is very good" she said proudly. She received all the tranches and technical support in time. Now, she is aware in Build Back Safer and explained some of the points as well. The house was colored properly and the surrounding was also clean. She is aware of hygiene and sanitation too. We came to know that she is also a member of 'Safa Gaun' (Clean Village) group. She even participated in the hygiene promotion sessions conducted by the Red Cross. She said, "We have to keep our surroundings clean, if we keep it dirty then we may suffer from different diseases". Joyfully, she thanked the Red Cross. She says, "The Red Cross has done a lot in our community. If we were not supported on time then we could not have completed our house. They even conducted different hygiene promotion sessions."

“Strong willpower to afford required amount is needed to reconstruct house in urban area”

Mr. Ramesh Bala Shrestha is a local resident of Ward-9, Tathali, Changunarayan Municipality, Bhaktapur.

Mr. Shrestha has recently rebuilt a reinforced concrete cement house, though finishing works are still remaining with window works and coloring of the house. He was forced to reside in temporary shelter for almost six years after the devastating Nepal Earthquake 2015, which damaged his previous Brick Mud Mortar house completely. Later when the terror of aftershocks was over, he continued to use the ground floor of the damaged house for domestic purposes and gave continuity to live in the temporary shelter made from CGI sheets.



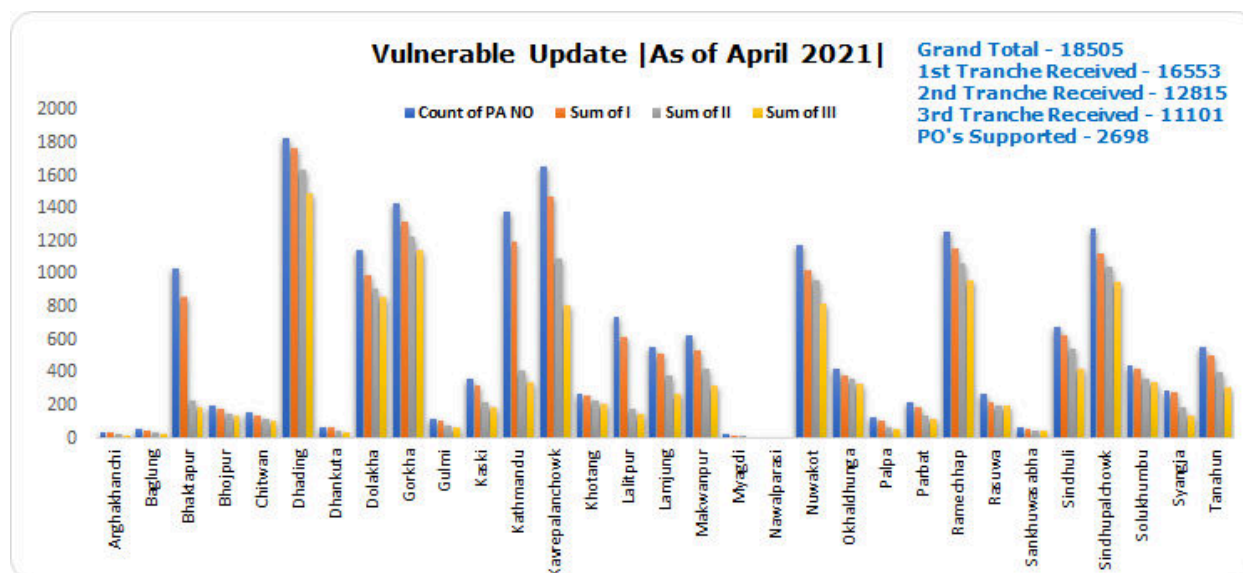
Before Earthquake 2015, he used to live in an extended family because he did not have a land ownership certificate, but his family started living separately post earthquake. In 2016,

he did partnership agreement with the Government of Nepal and then started processing for land ownership. Two years back, he managed to tenure the land under his ownership.

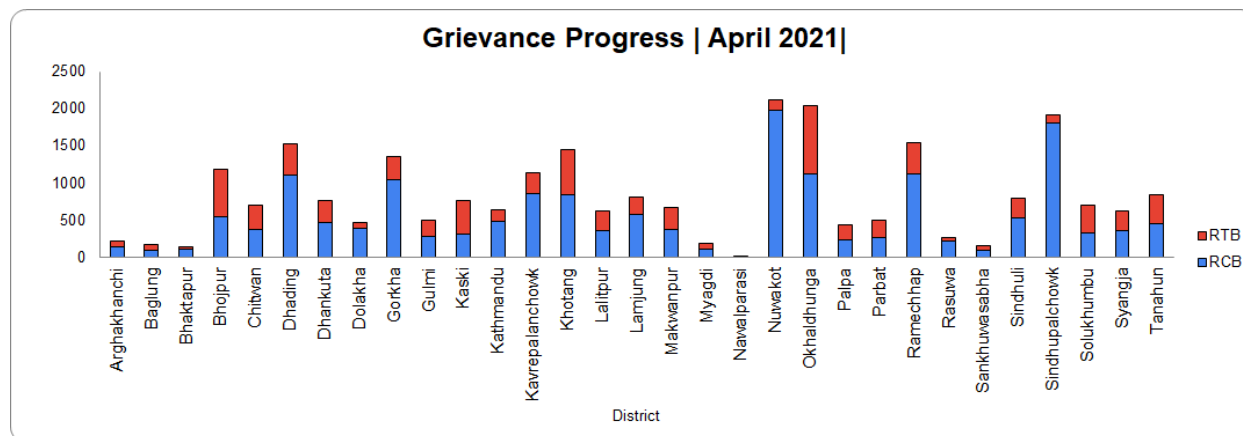
He runs a restaurant in a joint venture with his friends in Bhaktapur Durbar Square. But due to COVID 19 Crisis and lockdown in March 2020, he faced difficulty operating a restaurant business. Taking out his free time, he started a reconstructing house. He sold one of the plots under his ownership to accumulate sufficient amounts for house construction. He also utilized saving amounts, which he had deposited in the commercial banks after he returned back from foreign employment. He utilized the collected amount adequately in reconstructing earthquake resilient houses. His house reconstruction is almost completed and has received a third tranche. He did not hesitate to spend the amount to reconstruct an earthquake resilient house. He proudly shares, "My inner strength and willpower drove me to spend ample amounts of money to rebuild the house in urban areas, where price hiking is quite normal."

Vulnerable Households Reconstruction

Vulnerable Households Reconstruction (April 2021): As Of the total **18,505** NRA identified vulnerable households, 89% (**16,553**) have received the first tranche, 69% (**12,815**) have received the second tranche and 59% (**11,101**) have received the third tranche. In total 2,698 HHs have been supported by various partner organizations.



Grievances Data Update: As of April 2021, **25,203** grievances have been addressed by NRA, out of which **16,982** HHs have been enlisted as reconstruction beneficiaries and **8,221** as retrofitting beneficiaries



MEDIA COVERAGE & COMMUNICATION ON RECONSTRUCTION



[**Baliyo Ghar Surakshit Nepal | 9 April 2021:**](#) This episode focused on the event on taking forward urban housing reconstruction strategic issues with urban construction stakeholders. The program airs on Nepal Television every Friday 7:00 PM and every Saturday 10:30 AM.

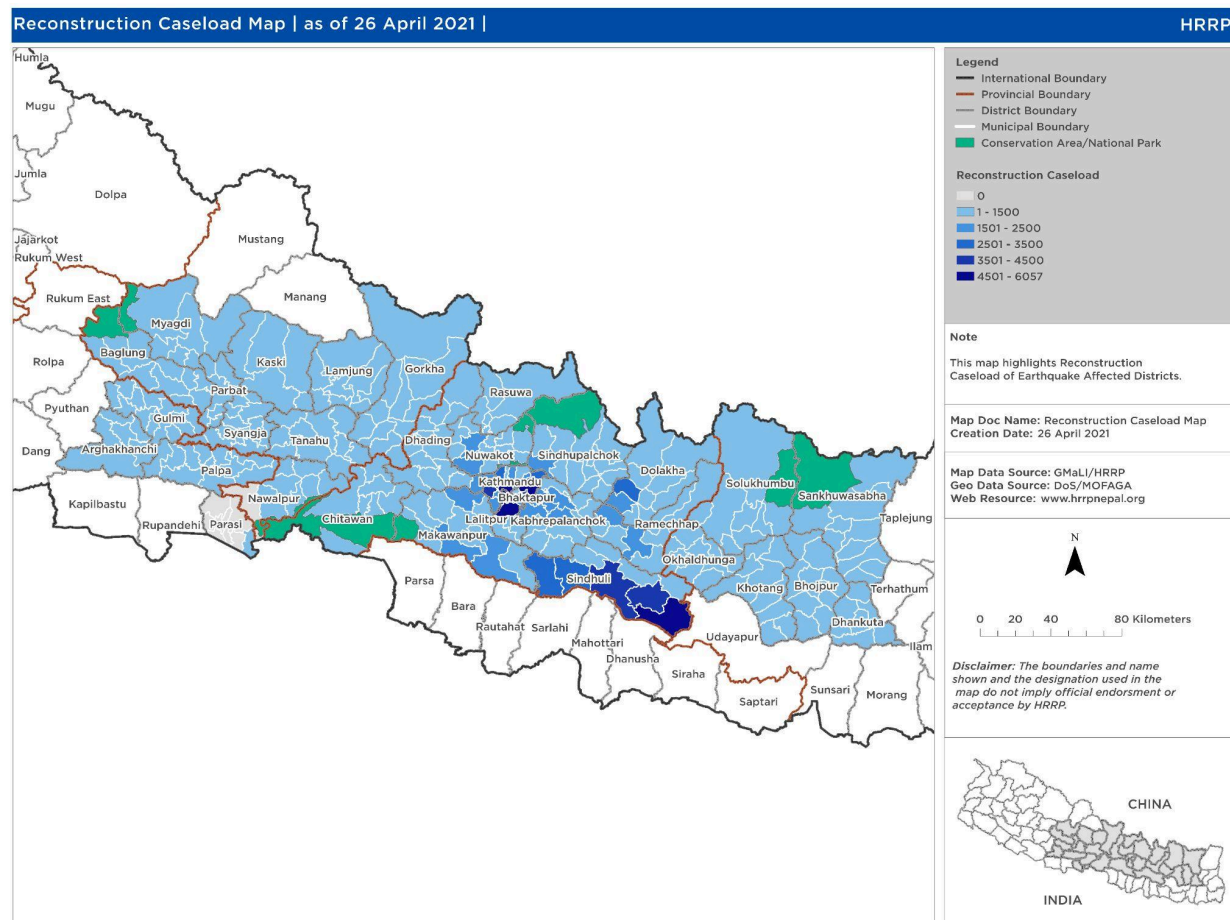
NATIONAL PRODUCTS

[**Monthly e-newsletter of NRA March 2021**](#)

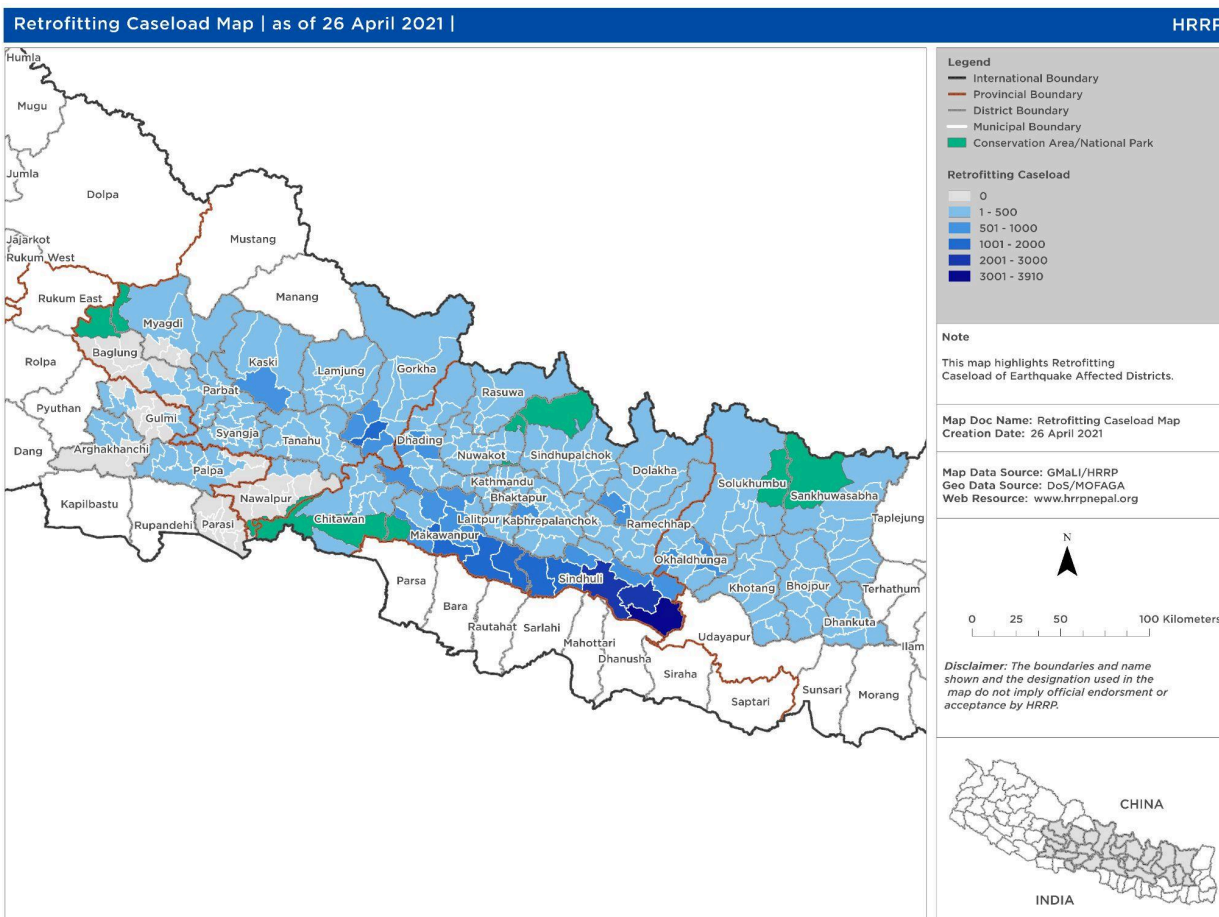
[**Rebuilding Nepal, English magazine of NRA, February-March 2021**](#)

HRRP PRODUCTS

Reconstruction Caseload Remaining (April 2021)



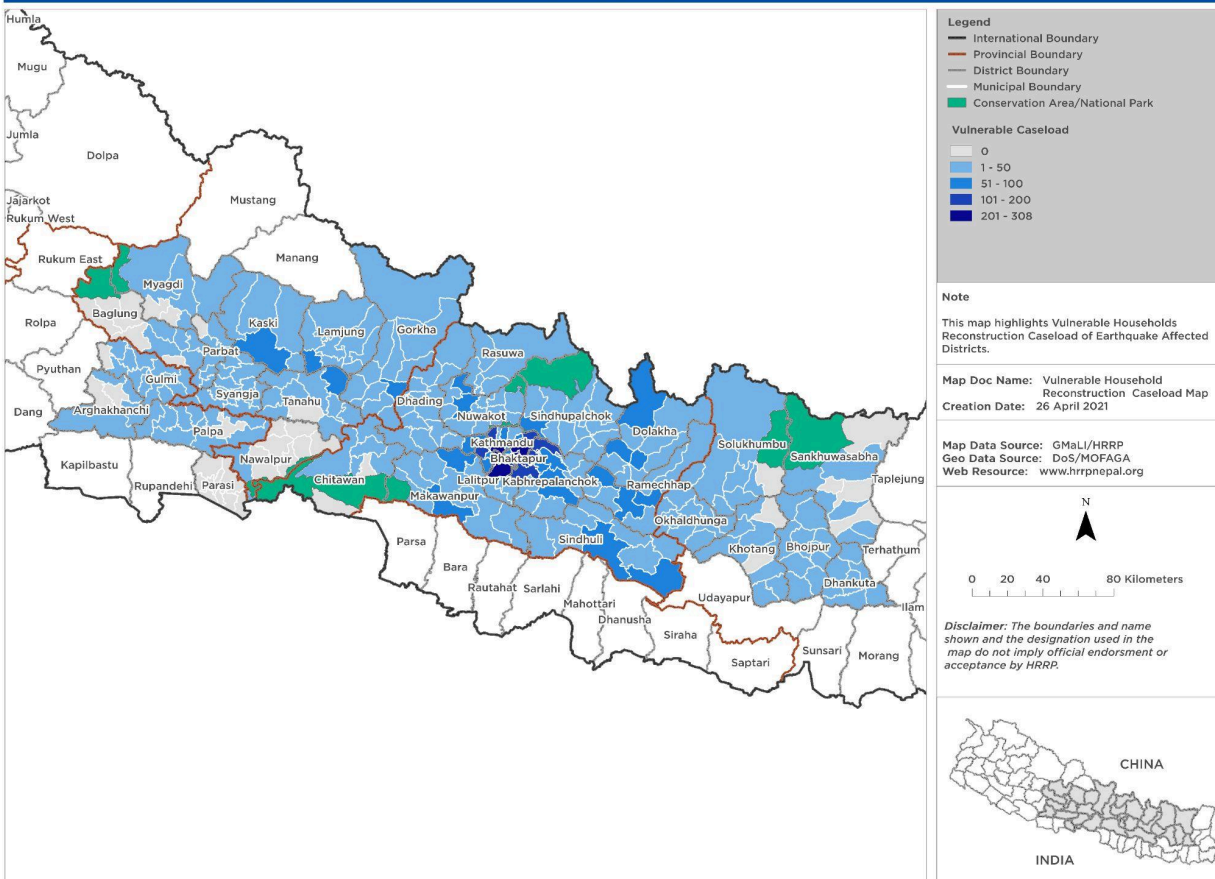
Retrofitting Caseload Remaining (April 2021)



Vulnerable Households Reconstruction Caseload Remaining (April 2021)

Vulnerable Household Reconstruction Caseload Map | as of 26 April 2021 |

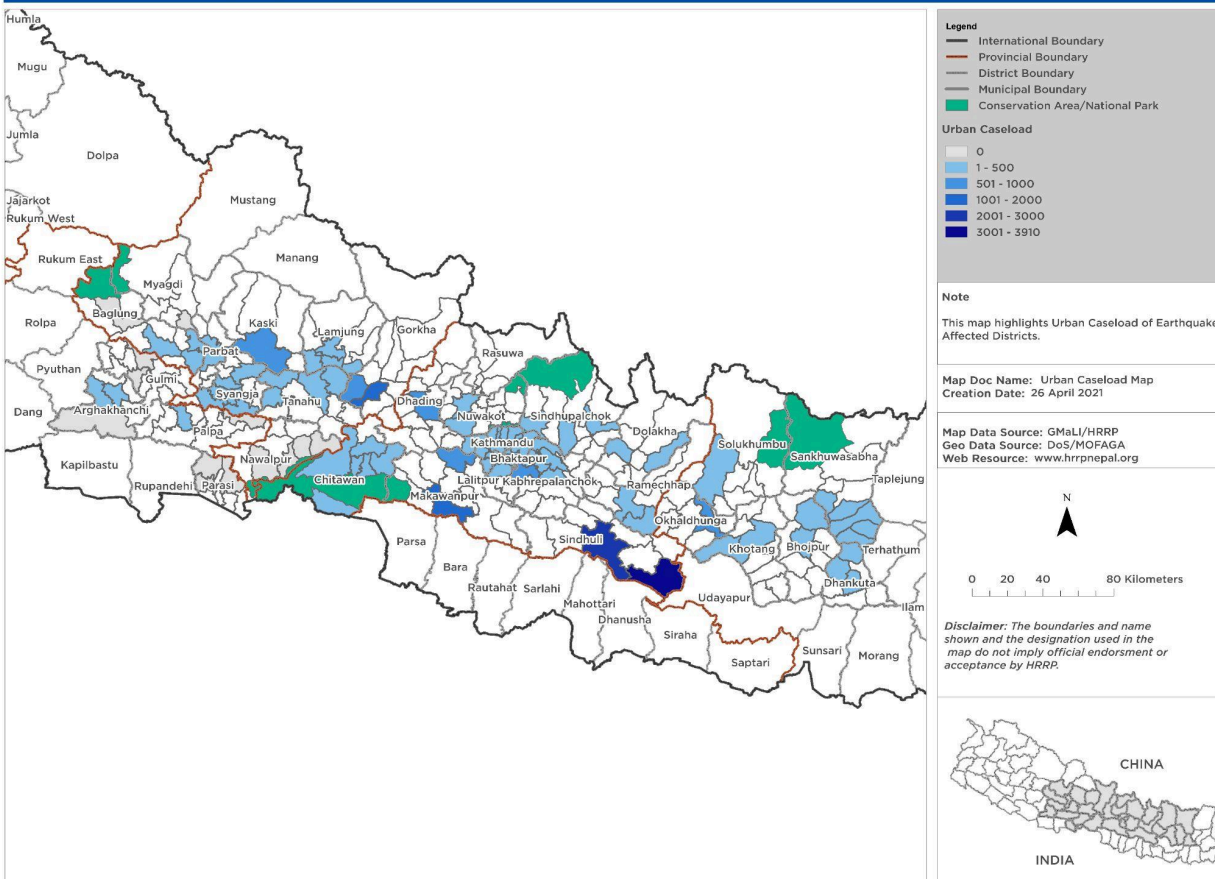
HRRP



Urban Reconstruction Caseload Remaining (April 2021)

Urban Caseload Map | as of 26 April 2021 |

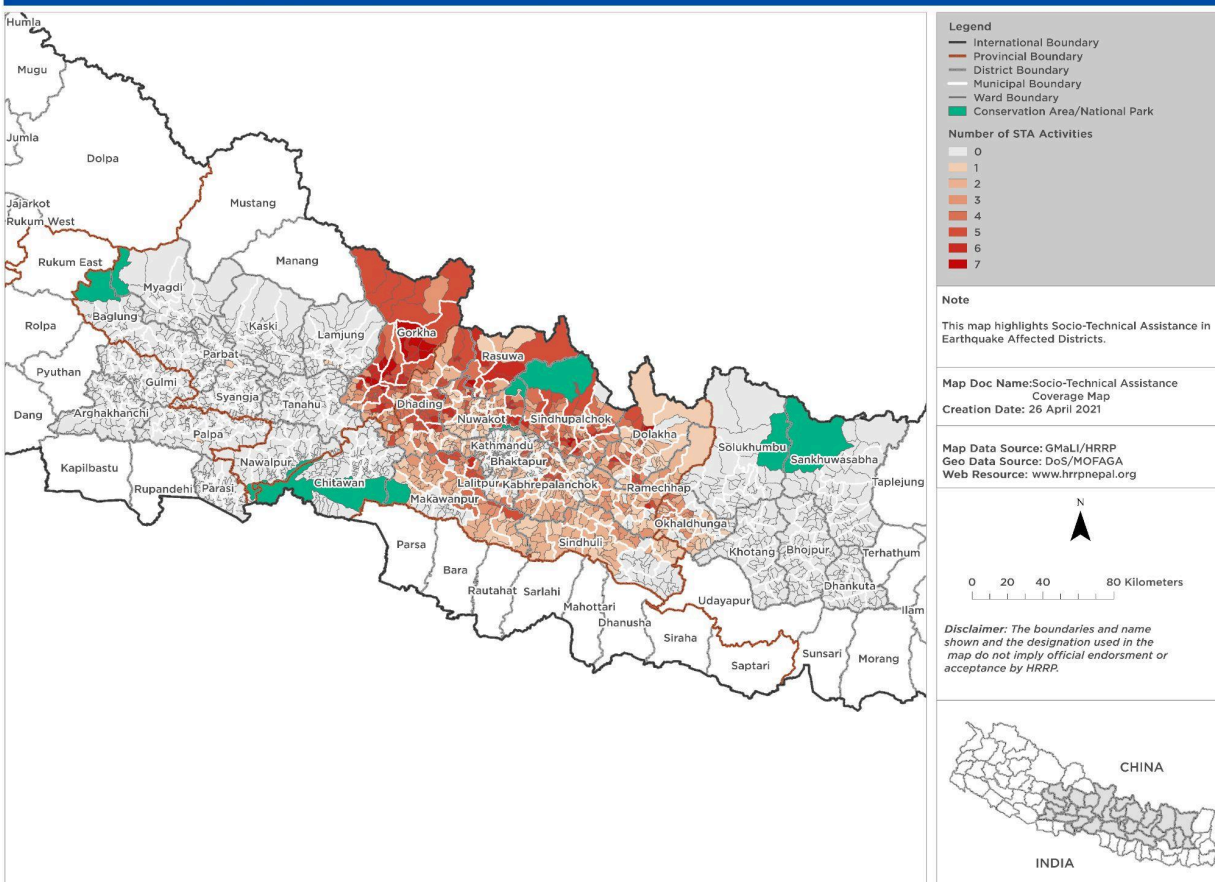
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Coverage of Socio Technical Assistance (April 2021): This is based on 5W data collection, April 2021.

Socio-Technical Assistance Coverage Map | as of 26 April 2021 |

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Palika Profiles (Municipal Reconstruction Profiles)

The recovery profiles contain various updates on the reconstruction and recovery at the Municipal level for all 282 earthquake-affected municipalities. The municipalities are updating the profiles on a monthly basis with technical support from HRRP.



Reconstruction and Retrofitting Information Pack

This highlights the reconstruction and retrofitting progress in all 32 earthquake-affected districts at the municipal level. This data is updated by HRRP district staff in close coordination with municipal focal persons. The links will be automatically updated to provide the reconstruction snapshot (PDF) for the month.



Municipal Dataset on Reconstruction

CSV, PDF

A composite dataset for 282 municipalities (urban status, damage grade, reconstruction, retrofitting and vulnerable HHs as identified by NRA can be assessed here as CSV and PDF). The dataset is updated by the municipalities with support from HRRP.

[FAQs](#) | [Briefing Pack](#) | [Meeting & Events](#) | [5W](#) | [Housing Progress](#) | [Housing Typologies](#)



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